Planning for Holistic Foundational Development

Perencanaan untuk Perkembangan Fondasi yang Holistik



From Curriculum Intention to Integrated Learning | Dr Emma Cross

Module 2 | A global university: Western Australia, Colombo, Dubai, Malaysia, Mauritius, Singapore

Where we are in the program

1. Curriculum as a Living Guide
2. **Planning for Holistic Foundational Development (you are here)**
3. Child-centred learning
4. Assessment for Learning
5. Strengthening Curriculum Implementation

Before today...

Your online work: seeing the whole child in planning

Whole child

Interconnected development

Curriculum as direction

Meaningful experiences

WHAT STAYED WITH YOU?

What is ONE idea from your online work that stayed with you?

THINK, then chat or microphone.

Today we move from seeing → planning

SEEING: Recognising holistic learning

→

PLANNING: Deliberately planning for it

What makes an experience meaningful?

THINK



Before we look at any terminology: what makes an experience meaningful for young children?

Mindful · Meaningful · Joyful

Language from the Indonesian Guide

Mindful

berkesadaran

Meaningful

bermakna

Joyful

menggembirakan

What might this look like in ECE?

Mindful

berkesadaran

Agency
Awareness
Engagement

Meaningful

bermakna

Connected to children's experience
Connected to context

Joyful

menggembirakan

Positive
Engaging
Challenging

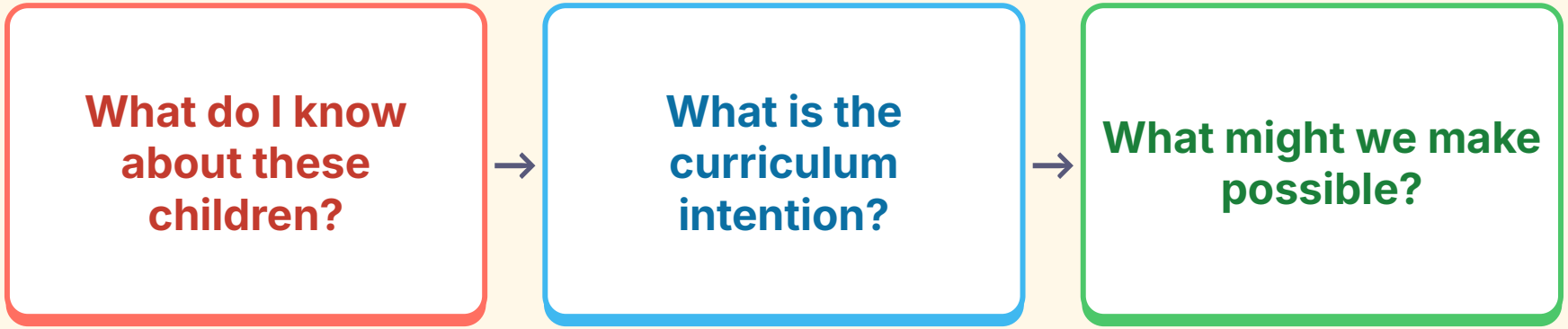
Planning is a cycle



Six questions to guide our thinking

1. What do I know about these children?
2. What is the curriculum intention?
3. What experience or environment might make this possible?
4. What do I notice and hear as children engage?
5. What does this tell me about their learning?
6. What next?

Planning begins with children AND curriculum



Understanding → Applying → Reflecting

Language from the Indonesian Guide

Understanding

memahami

Applying

mengaplikasi

Reflecting

merefleksi

What might that look like with young children?

Understanding

memahami

Encounter
Explore

Applying

mengaplikasi

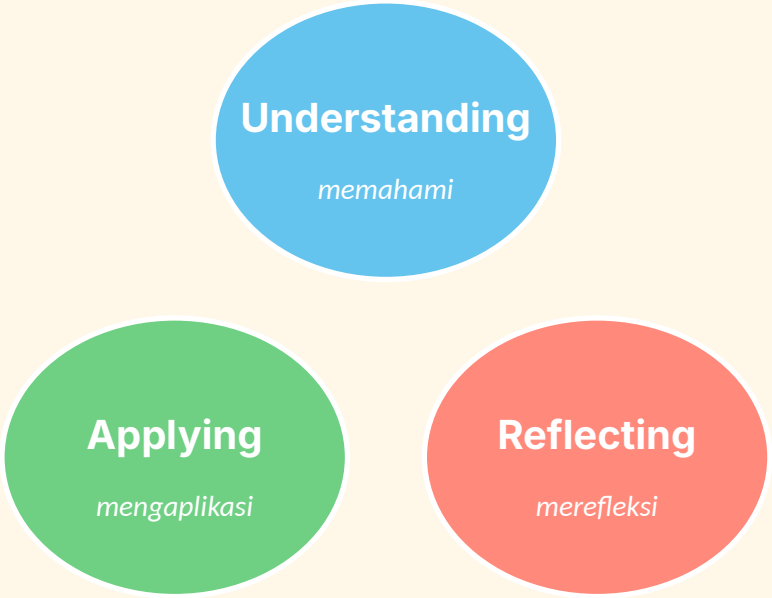
Try
Use
Investigate

Reflecting

merefleksi

Revisit
Represent
Talk about

Not three separate lessons



- These happen together, not in sequence
- Children move back and forth between them
- They can recur many times within one experience

Let’s put the planning cycle to work

CHALLENGE



“How can we move water from here to there?”

What might children do?

THINK · SHARE

Predict

?

?

?

What learning might be happening?

THINK · SHARE



Move from activity to learning, just as with the garden example online.

What might the educator do?

Notice

Respond

Extend

What might we notice?

Theories

Explanations

Strategies

Persistence

Collaboration

Use of materials

And then… what next?



For example, we might…

- Revisit photos with the children
- Redesign the set-up together
- Introduce a new material or constraint

Break

15 minutes | Istirahat

We will return at: _____

When we return: The Leaves plan

Something isn’t quite right here…

The Leaves plan

Theme: ‘Leaves’

Literacy

Children copy the word LEAF

Mathematics

Children complete a worksheet counting five leaves

Science

Teacher explains the parts of a leaf

Art

All children make the same leaf collage from a model

Social-emotional

Teacher reminds children to share.

What would you change?

How could children have more opportunity to… THINK → SHARE → CONNECT

explore

make decisions

communicate

investigate

connect learning

Same idea. Different planning.

Original plan

- Literacy: children copy the word LEAF
- Mathematics: children complete a worksheet counting five leaves
- Science: teacher explains the parts of a leaf
- Art: all children make the same leaf collage from a model
- Social-emotional: teacher reminds children to share.

Redesigned experience

Begin with children collecting and comparing leaves in the local environment. Invite their questions and theories. Provide magnifiers, drawing materials, sorting spaces and books/images as resources. Children decide ways to group, represent or investigate their collection. The educator listens, introduces language or concepts responsively, and uses observations to decide what to offer next.

Now apply the cycle to your context

Plan one experience using these six questions: 15 to 20 minutes

1. What do I know about these children?
2. What is the curriculum intention?
3. What experience or environment might make this possible?
4. What do I notice and hear as children engage?
5. What does this tell me about their learning?
6. What next?

BEFORE WE FINISH...

What is ONE change you could make to your planning process that would strengthen holistic learning?

Chat or verbal reflection.

Planning and assessment belong together



ONE IDEA TO TAKE WITH YOU

The plan is not the end point. It is a hypothesis about learning that becomes more useful when we observe what children actually do.